

INI CET

Subject-Wise Weightage Analysis

2021 – 2025 | All 10 Sessions | 19 Subjects

Exam	INI CET (Institute of National Importance Combined Entrance Test)
Conducted by	AIIMS, New Delhi
Sessions Analysed	May 2021, Nov 2021, May 2022, Nov 2022, May 2023, Nov 2023, May 2024, Nov 2024, May 2025, Nov 2025
Total Questions/Session	200 MCQs 3 Hours +1 correct / –1/3 incorrect marking
Subjects Covered	19 subjects across Pre-Clinical, Para-Clinical & Clinical phases
Data Sources	PrepLadder, DigiNerve, CollegeDekho, GetMyUni, Shiksha (memory-based recall; AIIMS does not release official papers)

Phase	Subjects	Avg Contribution
Pre-Clinical	Anatomy, Physiology, Biochemistry	~34–36 Qs (~17–18%)
Para-Clinical	Pathology, Pharmacology, Microbiology, Forensic Medicine, PSM	~57–60 Qs (~29–30%)
Clinical	Medicine, Surgery, OBGYN, Paediatrics, Ortho, Radiology, Dermatology, Ophthalmology, ENT, Anaesthesia, Psychiatry	~104–108 Qs (~52–54%)

Parameter	Details
Mode	Online CBT (Computer-Based Test)
Total Questions	200 MCQs per session
Duration	3 hours (180 minutes)
Section Format	4 sections x 50 questions x 45 min each (introduced Jan 2024); no section skipping allowed
Marking Scheme	+1 correct, –1/3 incorrect, 0 unattempted
Sessions per Year	2 sessions: January session (exam in November) and July session (exam in May)
Question Types	Single Best Answer, Multiple Correct, Image-Based, Extended Matching, Assertion-Reason

2. Subject-Wise Weightage — Average Across All 10 Sessions (2021–2025)

The figures below are averaged across all 10 INI CET sessions (May 2021 – Nov 2025). Since AIIMS does not publish official distributions, these represent best estimates from multi-source memory-based recall analyses. Expect ± 2 questions variance per subject.

#	Subject	Category	Avg Qs / Session	Min–Max Range	Avg Weightage %	5-Year Trend
1	General Medicine	Clinical	22.0	18–25	11.0%	▲ Increasing
2	General Surgery	Clinical	16.0	12–20	8.0%	▲ Increasing
3	Pharmacology	Para-Clinical	15.0	12–18	7.5%	▲ Increasing
4	OBGYN	Clinical	14.0	10–18	7.0%	→ Stable
5	Pathology	Para-Clinical	13.5	10–17	6.8%	→ Stable
6	Microbiology	Para-Clinical	12.5	10–16	6.3%	→ Stable
7	Biochemistry	Pre-Clinical	12.0	8–16	6.0%	▲ Increasing
8	Anatomy	Pre-Clinical	11.5	8–15	5.8%	→ Stable
9	PSM / Comm. Medicine	Para-Clinical	11.5	8–16	5.8%	→ Stable
10	Physiology	Pre-Clinical	11.0	8–14	5.5%	▼ Decreasing
11	Pediatrics	Clinical	8.5	5–12	4.3%	→ Stable
12	Orthopedics	Clinical	8.0	5–12	4.0%	▲ Increasing
13	Radiology	Clinical	6.5	4–10	3.3%	▲ Increasing
14	Dermatology	Clinical	6.5	4–10	3.3%	→ Stable
15	Ophthalmology	Clinical	6.0	4–9	3.0%	▼ Decreasing
16	Forensic Med. (FMT)	Para-Clinical	5.5	3–8	2.8%	→ Stable
17	ENT	Clinical	5.5	3–8	2.8%	→ Stable
18	Anaesthesia	Clinical	5.0	3–8	2.5%	→ Stable
19	Psychiatry	Clinical	5.0	3–8	2.5%	▲ Increasing
TOTAL		All Phases	200.0	—	100%	—

Row colours:	Blue = Pre-Clinical	Green = Para-Clinical	White/Grey = Clinical	▲ Green = Rising	▼ Red = Falling	→ Amber = Stable
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3. Session-Wise Paper Analysis — All 10 Sessions

Summary of key highlights from each INI CET session based on memory-based recall data compiled from major coaching platforms and student surveys.

Session	Exam Date	Top Subjects (Most Questions)	Difficulty	Key Observation
May 2021	22 Jul 2021	Dermatology, Forensics, Surgery, Medicine	Moderate–Difficult	First ever INI CET; image-based Qs heavy; dual-answer controversies
Nov 2021	14 Nov 2021	Medicine, Surgery, PSM, Biochemistry	Moderate	More theoretical than Jul; fewer images; clinical Qs prevalent
May 2022	8 May 2022	Pharmacology, Pathology, Microbiology	Moderate–Difficult	Image-based Qs in abundance; extended matching type Qs common
Nov 2022	13 Nov 2022	Biochemistry, Pharmacology, Pathology, PSM	Moderate	Well-balanced paper; PSM practical/field-based questions noted
May 2023	May 2023	Pharmacology, Biochemistry, Pathology, Medicine	Moderate–Tough	Lengthier paper; 50–55% clinical vignettes; image Qs balanced
Nov 2023	5 Nov 2023	Medicine, Ortho, Pharmacology, Psychiatry	Moderate–Difficult	NEW FORMAT: 4 sections x 50 Qs x 45 min each; Ortho & Psych prominent
May 2024	19 May 2024	Anatomy, Pharmacology, Ophthalmology, Medicine	Moderate–Difficult	Concept-based & clinical Qs dominant; 4-section format continued
Nov 2024	10 Nov 2024	Pathology, Pharma, Ortho, Medicine, OBGYN	Moderate–Difficult	Confusing Qs in Ortho & Path; 60–65% clinical vignettes; Psych up
May 2025	17 May 2025	Biochemistry, Surgery, Microbiology, Medicine	Moderate	Easier than previous year; one-liner Qs common; fewer OBGYN Qs
Nov 2025	Nov 2025	Medicine, Biochemistry, Surgery, Microbiology	Moderate–Difficult	30–40 image-based Qs; integrated multi-subject questions rising

Rise of Clinical Vignettes (% of paper)

Period	Clinical Vignette %	Image-Based Qs	Key Format Change
2021 Sessions	35–40%	~10–15	Single session format; memory-based Qs dominant
2022 Sessions	45–50%	~15–25	Extended matching Qs introduced; image Qs rise
2023 Sessions	50–55%	~20–25	Clinical integration across subjects increasing
2024–25 Sessions	55–65%	~30–40	4-section format; no skipping; pure recall Qs rare

4. High-Yield Topics per Subject

Subject	High-Yield Topics to Prioritise
General Medicine	Cardiology (ECG, heart failure), Endocrinology (DM, thyroid), Neurology, Nephrology, Infectious Diseases, Rheumatology
General Surgery	Breast, Thyroid, Hernia, GI tract, Trauma, Oncology principles, Orthopaedic classification systems
Pharmacology	Drug of choice (DOC) scenarios, Adverse drug reactions, Drug interactions (Warfarin, AEDs), Mechanisms of action
Pathology	Histopathology image identification, Tumour markers, Haematological malignancies, Cell injury & neoplasia
Microbiology	Bacteriology (culture media, virulence), Virology (HIV, HBV, HPV), Immunology, Vaccine schedules, Lab diagnosis
Biochemistry	Metabolic pathways, Enzyme deficiencies (inborn errors), Vitamins, Molecular biology & genetics, Acid-base
PSM	Biostatistics (sensitivity, specificity, NNT), National Health Programs, Epidemiology, Screening tests
Anatomy	Neuroanatomy (tracts, lesions), Embryology (developmental anomalies), Brachial plexus, Diaphragm
OBGYN	Obstetric emergencies (PPH, APH, PET), Labour management, Gynaecological malignancies, Contraception
Physiology	CVS (cardiac cycle, pressures), Renal physiology, Neurophysiology, Acid-base homeostasis
Pediatrics	Growth & developmental milestones, IMNCI, Neonatal conditions, Paediatric respiratory diseases
Orthopedics	Fracture classifications (Garden, Salter-Harris), Bone tumours, Paediatric ortho, Management algorithms
Radiology	X-ray signs, CT vs MRI indications, Contrast agents, ECG/CXR/USG image interpretation
Dermatology	Leprosy (classification, treatment), Psoriasis, STDs, Bullous disorders, Skin malignancies
Ophthalmology	Cataract surgery, Glaucoma types & management, Retinal disorders, Visual field defects
ENT	Audiometry types, CSOM complications, Vertigo (BPPV), Rhinoscleroma, Nasopharyngeal carcinoma
Anaesthesia	CPR protocols, Airway management (LMA, ET tube), IV anaesthetic agents, Monitoring parameters
Psychiatry	Mood disorders, Schizophrenia management, Substance abuse, Screening tools (PHQ-9, MMSE, HAM-D)
Forensic Med.	IPC sections (299–304, 375–376), Types of injuries, Identification of remains, Poisoning

5. Strategic Preparation Guide

Priority Tier	Subjects	Study Time	Expected Yield
TIER 1 Core — Must Master	Medicine, Surgery, Pharmacology, OBGYN, Pathology, Microbiology, PSM, Biochemistry	55–60%	~117–125 Qs (58–62%)
TIER 2 High-Value	Anatomy, Physiology, Pediatrics, Orthopedics, Radiology, Dermatology	25–30%	~48–55 Qs (24–28%)
TIER 3 Easy Scorers	Ophthalmology, ENT, Anaesthesia, Psychiatry, Forensic Medicine	10–15%	~27–32 Qs (14–16%)

Quick Reference — Subjects Ranked by Average Questions (per 200-Q paper)

Ran k	Subject	Category	Avg Qs	Weightage %	Trend
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3	Physiology	Pre-Clinical	11.0	5.5%	▼ Decreasing
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18	Anaesthesia	Clinical	5.0	2.5%	→ Stable
19	Psychiatry	Clinical	5.0	2.5%	▲ Increasing

10 Key Takeaways

1. **Medicine dominates** — 18–25 questions every session; Cardiology, Endocrinology, Neurology are the top subtopics.
2. The **BIG SIX** (Medicine + Surgery + Pharmacology + Pathology + Microbiology + OBGYN) contribute ~55–60% of the paper.
3. **Clinical vignettes** now make up 55–65% of the paper (2024–25); pure memory-based questions are rapidly declining.
4. **Image-based questions** have risen to 30–40 per session — histopathology, ECG, radiology images are essential.
5. The **4-section format** (since Jan 2024) means you cannot skip subjects; each 45-min section must be managed independently.
6. **Short subjects** (Psychiatry, FMT, ENT, Anaesthesia, Ophthalmology, Dermatology) together contribute 25–30 Qs — don't ignore them.
7. **Pharmacology and Biochemistry are RISING** — clinical application of drugs and molecular biology are the new focus.

8. **Orthopedics** has seen a spike in difficulty and frequency since 2023 — classification systems and paediatric ortho are high-yield.
9. **~20–30% of concepts repeat** across sessions — solving the last 6 sessions' PYQs is non-negotiable.
10. Negative marking ($-1/3$) means attempt only when reasonably confident; target 175–185 questions with high accuracy.

DISCLAIMER: AIIMS, New Delhi does not officially release INI CET question papers or subject-wise question counts. All data is derived from memory-based recall analyses published by PrepLadder, DigiNerve, CollegeDekho, GetMyUni, and Shiksha based on student feedback after each session. Figures are best estimates and may vary by $\pm 2-3$ questions per subject. This document is intended solely as a study-planning reference. | Compiled: May 2026.